comparisons with aspects of China, and engagingly portrayed the contemporary social challenges facing both countries.[80]

Indian Perceptions of China and the Chinese

This chapter has so far dealt quite a lot with Chinese views of India. In fact, there is data, both quantitative and more impressionistic, of Indian views of China and the Chinese.

The China threat

The Pew surveys of Indian and Chinese opinion of other nations show just how consistently negative the two are about each other. Between 2014 and 2019, when Indians were asked if they had a favourable attitude towards China, on average only 27 per cent said yes. In 2018, the year after the Doklam confrontation, that number fell to 12 per cent. This was more negative than US views but less negative than Japanese views of China. Between 2014 and 2016 (there are no Pew surveys in China beyond 2016), when the Chinese were asked the same question about India, on average only 26 per cent said they had a favourable view. In 2019, 40 per cent of Indians also said that China was having a negative effect on their economic conditions, 61 per cent responded that China's growing economy was bad for India, and 73 per cent thought that China's growing military might was also negative for India. In 2017, 44 per cent of Indians polled thought that China's 'power and influence' was a major threat to India's security (though the terrorist threat of ISIS and climate change were ranked as greater).[81]

Indian racism and jingoism

While no one seems to have done a systematic study of Indian attitudes towards China and the Chinese, we know that racism and disdain in India